TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

# Catch Up With Someone You Haven't Seen for a Long Time

Narrate | PPF | Experience Sharing

Name: _____ Date: _____

## SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

**Catch up with someone you have not seen for years: tell two or three things that happened, what you do now and what is next, then ask about their news.**

| | |
|---|---|
| WHO | Three years ago you and Amy worked in the same office. Then she left to become a coach, and you have not seen each other since. |
| SITUATION | Saturday night, a wedding dinner at a Chinese restaurant in JB. Amy is at your table. Before the food comes, she says: “Long time no see! It’s been three years. So, what’s new?” |
| NEED | Amy wants the main news, not every detail: two or three things that happened, what you do now and what you are planning. She wants to tell you her news too. |
| GOAL | Tell your news in order (then → now → next), with two or three highlights, and ask her back, so it is a conversation, not a speech. |

## SLIDE 03 Try it first

Amy asks: “Hey! Long time no see! It’s been three years. So, what’s new with you?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

## SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti's answer. Mark where each part starts.

When we last met, four years ago, I was still working at the travel agency in town. Then in 2023, I joined a small company, and last year I got married! These days, I'm in HR there. We're only twelve people, so I know everyone, and so far I've really enjoyed it. Next year, we're going to buy our own place, probably a small condo in Tebrau, near my husband's parents. But enough about me! What about you? Are you still at the travel agency these days?

P THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

_____

P NOW · THESE DAYS

_____

F NEXT · THE PLAN

_____

! ASK THEM BACK

_____

## SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling meets an old neighbour at the mall after five years: then → now → next → ask back.

- ☐ Anyway, that's me. What about you? Is your family still in Skudai these days?
- ☐ Five years ago, when we were neighbours in Skudai, I was still working at a hardware shop. After that, I took a night course.
- ☐ Next year, I'm going to start a diploma in accounting. It takes two years.
- ☐ These days, I'm an accounts assistant in JB, and I check about 200 invoices a month.

Write the letter: **P** = Then · since we last met · **P** = Now · these days · **F** = Next · the plan · **!** = Ask them back

## SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

### THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

- [ ] When we last met, I was still …
- [ ] Then in (year), I …
- [ ] After that, I …
- [ ] Last year, I …

### NOW

- [ ] These days, I'm …
- [ ] Right now, I …
- [ ] So far, it's been …

### NEXT

- [ ] Next year, I'm going to …
- [ ] I'm planning to …
- [ ] I'm hoping to …

### ASK THEM BACK · REACT

- [ ] Really? That's great!
- [ ] But enough about me.
- [ ] What about you?
- [ ] Are you still …?

---

## SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I left the travel agency in 2023. [ Or / For example, / Then ] I joined a small company in town.

2. When we last met, I was single. [ because / but / for example, ] Now I'm married!

3. I'm studying at night. [ or / for example, / because ] I want a better job next year.

4. I finish the diploma next June. [ After that, / For example, / So far, ] I'm going to ask for a promotion.

## SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Then in 2023, I _____ a small company. (Something that happened, with a year)
   - ○ joining
   - ○ joined
   - ○ was join
2. When we last met, I _____ at a travel agency. (The background: your life when you last met)
   - ○ was work
   - ○ were working
   - ○ was working
3. These days, I _____ in HR. (Your life these days)
   - ○ working
   - ○ am work
   - ○ work
4. Next year, we _____ buy our own place. (A plan)
   - ○ going to
   - ○ are going to
   - ○ are go to

---

## SLIDE 09 Setting the scene: was / were + -ing

To say what your life was like when you last met, use was / were + -ing (add still). For the things that happened after that, use the past simple with a time.

When we last met, I **was** still **working** at the travel agency.

Five years ago, we **were living** next door in Skudai.

Then in 2023, I **joined** a small company.

Are you **still working** there these days?

SLIDE 10

# Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

**When we last met, I was still … Then in …, I …**

P

NOW · THESE DAYS

**These days, I'm …**

F

NEXT · THE PLAN

**Next year, I'm going to …**

!

ASK THEM BACK

**But enough about me! What about you?**

SLIDE 11

# Experience Sharing

Two old friends catch up. Each tells two or three things in order, now and next, then asks back: from a card first, then their own news. The listener cannot see the card and fills the catch-up note.

1. Quiet time (2:00): read your card. Choose two or three things that happened. Plan: then → now → next → ask back.
2. Round 1 (3:00 each), your card: tell, then ask back. Partner writes the note, reads it back: 'First you …, then …'.
3. Line B moves one seat. Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, new partner, shorter: only two things, now, next, ask back.
4. Line B moves. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed, workbook turned over: your own real news (or your card again).

**Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel**

**Card 2 · Old friend from badminton**

**Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory**

**Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school**

Catch-up note

| | ROUND 1 | ROUND 2 | ROUND 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Since then: when, what** | | | |
| **Now** | | | |
| **Next, and when?** | | | |
| **Asked me back? Yes / No** | | | |

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

## SLIDE 12 Respond

Amy asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Oh, when did that happen?**
2. **And what is that like these days?**
3. **So when does that start?**

Start with: **It was about … ago. / In …, I … · It's good. These days, I … · Next …, I'm going to …**

---

## SLIDE 13 Transfer

Kumar is back in the office after four months at a customer's factory in Melaka. At lunch he asks you: 'So, what's new with you?' Tell him two things that happened at work, what you are doing now and what is next. Then ask about him. No news? Use these: two months ago, Ali changed all the office computers · last month, a new colleague joined your team · now: you are training her · next month: the annual dinner.

**After you left, I … · These days, I'm … · Next month, I'm going to … · And what about you? How was Melaka?**

---

## SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Tells two or three things that happened, in order, each with a time word.
- [ ] Says what they do now and what they plan next.
- [ ] Asks the other person back about their news.

---

SLIDE 15

# Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Two or three things, in order | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Now and next | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Asking back | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Useful expressions | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Confidence | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |

**My improvement action:** Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

**After class: open the After class review**

SLIDE 11

# Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

**Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel**

An old colleague. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'How is it going?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

**Card 2 · Old friend from badminton**

An old friend. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask about the plan: 'Which month?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

**Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory**

An old colleague. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'When did that happen?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

**Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school**

An old classmate. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'What is a normal day like?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

SLIDE 11

# Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

**Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel**

2024: my son was born · Now: the stall opens 6 days a week, 6 a.m. to 1 p.m. · Last met: 5 years ago, both on the front desk · Bought a new phone · In January: start selling online · 2023: opened a nasi lemak stall in Skudai

**Card 2 · Old friend from badminton**

Next year, in June: take the family to Japan · Last met: 4 years ago, in Kluang · Got a new car · Now: at an insurance company, working from home 3 days a week · 2022: moved to JB · 2025: finished a part-time degree

**Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory**

Joined a gym · 2021: moved to Singapore, 3 years in a warehouse · Now: office manager at a clinic in Kulai · Last met: 6 years ago, in Pasir Gudang · In December: getting married · 2024: came back to JB to look after my mother

**Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school**

Now: driving a school van, 2 trips a day, 6.30 a.m. and 1 p.m. · Last met: 3 years ago, at a class reunion · Last year: moved to a condo in Permas Jaya · Next year: buy a second van · New hair colour · 2024: left a shipping office